RESIDENTIAL LIFE / 2026–27

Grand River University

Resident Handbook

Policies, services and day-to-day guidance for living on campus.

Fictional campus simulation. All campus contact numbers are placeholders.

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CHAPTER 01

Welcome and how to use this handbook

01.0 About this edition

Grand River University (GRU) is a fictional residential university. This 2026–27 handbook, its housing agreement examples, dates, fees, and contact information are simulation data. All numbers starting with XXX are placeholders. For real emergencies, use your local emergency services.

01.1 Who does what

Residential Life supports the social and academic life of the halls. Resident Assistants (RAs) help with community concerns and roommate agreements. Hall Directors supervise each building and review urgent housing or safety concerns. Housing Assignments handles contracts, billing, placement, and room changes. Campus Services oversees desks, mail, and facilities. Campus Dining and the Student Programs Board maintain their own schedules.

01.2 Which information to use

Use this handbook for residential policies, the campus directory for contacts and building details, and dated dining and events records for daily schedules. A dated closure or revised event record takes precedence over a regular schedule. If an answer depends on your specific contract, room placement, or pending request, contact the relevant office.

01.3 Community involvement

Each district has a resident council that proposes programs and allocates small event funds. Apply through the hall desk at any point in the term. Participation is optional. Floor meetings convey operational information, and residents who miss one may request the notes from their RA.

CHAPTER 02

Safety, reporting and support

02.1 Immediate danger and urgent building issues

During a real emergency, contact local emergency services. In the fictional campus scenario, the GRU Police Dispatch line represents the campus safety contact. Report active water leaks, loss of heat in cold weather, a door that will not lock, and broken glass in a corridor to your staffed desk or the overnight duty line. Use a maintenance ticket for routine repairs.

02.2 Missing residents and emergency contacts

You can report a missing resident to campus dispatch immediately. There is no required waiting period. Provide the last known location and time if you have them. In the housing portal you may designate a confidential missing-person contact separately from your general emergency contact. Staff use the contact only as permitted under the relevant reporting procedure.

02.3 Counseling, care and accessibility

The Wellness Center schedules confidential counseling appointments and operates a same-day triage queue on weekdays. Student Care coordinates practical support after a crisis, hospitalization, or loss of housing. Access Services coordinates disability accommodations. The housing desk may relay contact information without asking for medical details.

02.4 Bystander response

If safe to do so, seek assistance from staff, stay nearby, and give responders the location and what you observed. Students who seek timely assistance for a substance-related medical emergency can request a medical-assistance review for the associated possession or consumption concern. The review considers cooperation and does not prevent separate action regarding violence or other harm.

CHAPTER 03

Housing eligibility and accommodations

03.1 Live-on requirement

Full-time first-year undergraduates ordinarily live in university housing for their first two enrolled semesters. Students may request an exemption for a documented disability-related need, living with a parent or guardian within 35 road miles, primary caregiving, military service obligations, or an approved financial hardship. An exemption is effective when written approval arrives. Applying does not release an existing agreement.

03.2 Accommodation requests

Start with Access Services for an accessible room, private or nearby bathroom, approved cooling unit, assistance animal, or dining accommodation. Submit fall priority requests by June 15 and spring priority requests by November 15. Later requests are accepted and may require an interim arrangement depending on availability. Housing communicates implementation details separately from the confidential review.

03.3 Gender-inclusive, recovery and family housing

Gender-inclusive rooms are available by opt-in during selection or by request afterward. Residents may update their placement preferences through Housing Assignments. Bracken Hall includes a substance-free floor. Residents on that floor agree to keep alcohol and recreational drugs out of the community even when they are of legal age. Cedar Court has a limited set of partner and dependent units with a separate agreement.

03.4 Residents under 18

A parent or legal guardian completes the guarantor acknowledgment before check-in when required by the agreement. Residents receive the same housing support channels. Staff follow the applicable campus protocol when an incident involves a minor or a guardian notification.

CHAPTER 04

Resident rights and shared responsibilities

04.1 Resident rights

Residents may use assigned spaces, sleep and study without unreasonable disruption, request disability accommodations, and report concerns without retaliation. Staff will explain the relevant policy and response options when reviewing an incident, subject to privacy limits.

04.2 Resident responsibilities

Keep access credentials secure, follow posted capacity rules, cooperate with evacuations and authorized repairs, and address guest behavior. Keep the path from beds to the exit clear. Review your room inventory, report problems promptly, and consult your roommate before changing shared arrangements.

04.3 Housing responsibilities

Housing maintains assigned facilities, provides a reporting path at all hours, documents significant changes, and makes reasonable efforts to provide comparable accommodations during an outage. Temporary measures may be announced by email, at the desk, and on building signage. Residents can request a review if a reassignment creates an accessibility or financial issue.

CHAPTER 05

Hall access, keys and identification

05.1 Building access

Residential floors require resident card access at all hours. Lobby public access typically runs 07:00–20:00. During an event, public access applies only to the advertised public venue and route. Dining entrances have independent hours. Do not prop secure doors or admit unknown people behind you.

05.2 Lockouts and lost credentials

During desk hours, visit the desk with a photo ID or complete an identity check with desk staff. After closing, use the duty line. The first two assisted lockouts each semester are free. Later assisted lockouts cost $12 each. Lost physical keys may require a $55 lock change, billed separately. Disable a lost campus card in the portal and alert the desk promptly.

05.3 Guests and overnight stays

A host may sign in up to two guests at a time and must accompany them beyond the lobby. Guests aged 16 and up show photo ID. Guests under 16 stay with their parent or guardian during the visit. Overnight visits require agreement from every assigned roommate and registration by 22:00. Each guest may stay up to two consecutive nights and five nights in a rolling 30-day period campuswide. During break periods, guest access is subject to the published closure notice.

CHAPTER 06

Noise, privacy and roommate agreements

06.1 Quiet and courtesy hours

Quiet hours are 22:00–08:00 Sunday through Thursday nights and 00:00–09:00 for Friday and Saturday nights, meaning Friday and Saturday evening gatherings end by midnight. Courtesy hours apply around the clock. During finals, continuous quiet hours begin at 18:00 the evening before the first scheduled exam day and end when the final exam period closes.

06.2 Recording and privacy

Obtain permission from people you intend to record in rooms, lounges, and other residential areas. Recording in bathrooms, shower rooms, and changing areas is prohibited. Door cameras and devices pointed into residential corridors require written Housing approval. Share documentation of an incident directly with staff when possible.

06.3 Roommate conflicts and harassment

Complete the roommate agreement in the first two weeks. Discuss schedules, visitors, shared items, temperature, and cleaning. An RA can help mediate ordinary disagreements. Report threats, harassment, discrimination, stalking, or retaliation to a Hall Director or the appropriate campus reporting office. A resident may request an interim separation while staff review safety concerns.

CHAPTER 07

Alcohol, drugs, smoking and other conduct

07.1 Alcohol and controlled substances

Residents who may legally possess alcohol may keep it in their assigned room if every assigned occupant is of legal drinking age and the room is outside a substance-free area. Open containers are prohibited in shared corridors and lounges. Common-source containers and drinking games are prohibited in halls. Recreational cannabis is prohibited in residential spaces. Store prescribed medication securely and use it only as directed.

07.2 Smoking and vaping

Smoking, vaping, and burning tobacco or cannabis are prohibited inside and within 30 feet of residence entrances, operable windows, and air intakes. Report repeated smoke exposure to the desk, and report active smoke or fire through emergency channels.

07.3 Weapons, fireworks and gambling

Weapons, realistic replicas, ammunition, fireworks, and explosive materials are prohibited in residence facilities except where expressly authorized by written campus rules. Report concerning objects to campus dispatch. Money wagering and paid-entry gambling are prohibited in residential areas unless a specifically authorized campus activity permits them.

CHAPTER 08

Appliances, cooking, cooling and electrical use

08.1 Personal appliances

Each bedroom may have one compact refrigerator up to 3.8 cubic feet and one microwave rated up to 800 watts cooking output. Plug refrigerators and microwaves directly into wall outlets. Use a listed surge protector for low-power electronics. Do not connect power strips to one another or route cords under rugs or through doorways.

08.2 Cooking and grilling

Electric kettles with automatic shutoff are allowed in bedrooms. Air fryers, hot plates, electric skillets, toaster ovens, and countertop grills belong in designated community kitchens during staffed hours. Return the kitchen to a clean condition and stay with active cooking. Outdoor grilling is limited to installed grills when the courtyard is open. Personal grills and fuel canisters are prohibited.

08.3 Cooling, heating and ventilation

Portable heaters and resident-installed air conditioners are prohibited. A personal fan is allowed if vents and walkways stay clear. For an approved cooling accommodation, Facilities selects and installs equipment. Never remove window stops or screens, hang objects from windows, or access roofs, ledges, and service balconies.

CHAPTER 09

Fire protection, evacuation and mobility

09.1 Alarms and drills

Leave promptly using marked stairs when an alarm sounds and follow staff directions at the assembly point. Residents needing an individualized evacuation plan may coordinate it with Access Services and Housing. Return when responders give clearance. Follow the posted severe-weather shelter route when directed.

09.2 Fire prevention and equipment

Candles, incense, open flames, and combustible storage in exits are prohibited. Keep detectors, sprinkler heads, alarm stations, and extinguishers clear. Tampering with equipment or using emergency exits for routine access may trigger a conduct review. Decorative lights must be listed and used according to their instructions.

09.3 Bikes, scooters and mobility aids

Store bicycles in racks or assigned storage. Personal electric scooters and e-bike batteries may be stored or charged only at designated outdoor stations. Residents who use medically necessary powered mobility devices may arrange an approved indoor storage and charging location with Access Services. Keep exits, stairwells, and corridor widths clear.

CHAPTER 10

Animals, bathrooms and use of shared space

10.1 Pets and approved animals

One freshwater aquarium up to eight gallons is allowed per bedroom with roommate agreement. Animals otherwise enter housing only under an applicable service-animal policy, written assistance-animal approval, or an authorized program. Residents are responsible for sanitation and control. Work with Access Services when room access or placement affects an accommodation.

10.2 Bathrooms and shared spaces

Use designated bathrooms and honor posted cleaning closures. Keep personal belongings in assigned cubbies or your room. A lounge can be reserved through the desk for up to two hours, subject to capacity and accessible routes. Athletic games, bouncing balls, and similar activities belong in outdoor or recreation facilities.

10.3 Laundry and common area damage

Laundry is included for hall residents. Machines run 07:00–23:00. Report machine failures by location and machine number. Staff document damage or extensive cleanup and give residents a chance to provide information before any shared charge. Individually attributable costs are billed to the responsible resident when established.

CHAPTER 11

Posting, elections, canvassing and business

11.1 Flyers and digital notices

Registered groups may submit one flyer per hall to the desk. Accepted materials receive a removal date no later than the event date plus two days or 14 days after posting, whichever comes first. Staff use designated boards. Floor doors, elevators, fire equipment, and windows are excluded from posting.

11.2 Elections and outreach

Campus election groups and registered organizations may request a staffed lobby table with three business days' notice. Participation must be voluntary. Door-to-door canvassing and collecting signatures on residential floors are prohibited. Ask the desk about permitted public locations when a hall lobby is unavailable.

11.3 Commercial activity

Running a walk-in business, storing resale inventory that interferes with residence use, and selling products door to door are prohibited. A resident may perform remote work from a room within ordinary noise and network rules. Student sales events require venue approval and must use approved common areas.

CHAPTER 12

Assignments, vacancies and room changes

12.1 Choosing a room

Housing offers selection windows based on class year, documented accommodations, and application timing. Returning residents can form roommate groups before their assigned window. Room type and roommate requests depend on availability. Assignments can change when capacity, accessibility, or safety requires.

12.2 Transitional placement and open beds

When permanent inventory is full, Housing may assign a temporary room at a disclosed rate and offer a permanent placement as space opens. Keep vacant beds, desks, and closets usable for a new roommate. Housing sends notice when practical before filling an open space, including at midyear.

12.3 Room changes

Standard requests open after the tenth class day and require written approval before either resident moves. Staff can review urgent health or safety requests immediately. After approval, collect new access, complete both inventories, and return old keys within 48 hours unless a different move window is specified.

CHAPTER 13

Furniture, repairs and room entry

13.1 Furnishings and decorations

Each bed space has a bed, desk, chair, and clothing storage. Leave supplied furniture in the assigned room. Use removable mounting strips and keep door decorations to less than half the door surface. Painting, drilling, covering ceilings, and attaching items to sprinkler systems are prohibited.

13.2 Bed adjustments, cleaning and condition

Request approved bed adjustments through Facilities. Resident-built lofts and furniture modifications are prohibited. Submit your room condition report within 72 hours of check-in. Clean your assigned space regularly and document pre-existing wear before the deadline to help staff distinguish damage from ordinary use.

13.3 Repairs and authorized entry

For routine maintenance, submit a ticket with the room number and description. A submitted ticket authorizes entry for that work during 09:00–18:00 unless an alternate appointment is arranged. Staff normally provide at least 24 hours' notice for scheduled inspections. Urgent hazards, welfare concerns, and emergency repairs may require immediate entry. Staff document the reason and attempt to inform residents afterward.

CHAPTER 14

Mail, packages, deliveries and lost property

14.1 Address format and pickup

Use the resident's name on file, room number and hall name, and the hall's delivery address listed in the campus directory. The desk accepts ordinary carrier packages when staffed and sends a separate pickup notice after scanning. Show a campus card or complete the desk's ID check.

14.2 Perishables and unclaimed items

Meet grocery, restaurant, medication courier, and other time-sensitive deliveries in the public lobby. Desks accept standard carrier parcels subject to size limits and refuse prohibited hazardous items. Standard parcels are held for seven staffed days before return when possible. Change your shipping address before you leave. Package forwarding is unavailable.

14.3 Missing mail and lost property

Ask the carrier for proof of delivery, then bring the tracking number to the desk. For lost property, check the desk where the item was found. Ordinary property is held for 14 calendar days. Staff send IDs and keys to the issuing office and route sensitive items to campus dispatch.

CHAPTER 15

Move-in, breaks and move-out

15.1 2026–27 residential calendar

Fall move-in runs August 27–30, 2026. Fall regular occupancy ends December 19 at noon. Spring check-in opens January 9, 2027 at noon. Spring checkout closes May 8 at noon. Residents may request a later departure for a documented need. Approved dates are communicated separately.

15.2 Break access and winter housing

Halls stay open during the fall recess. Winter break housing operates only in Alder and Juniper from December 19 at noon until January 9 at noon. Apply by December 4. Approved residents assigned elsewhere may receive a temporary room. Dining, package pickup, and visitor access follow separate break schedules.

15.3 Checkout, damage and abandoned property

Schedule checkout with the desk or use express checkout where offered. Remove belongings, clean surfaces, remove trash, and return keys. Express checkout gives staff permission to inspect later. Staff may bill documented costs for repair, excess cleaning, unreturned access items, or abandoned belongings. Residents have ten business days from notice to request a billing review.

CHAPTER 16

Accountability, notices and appeals

16.1 Responding to a report

Staff document concerns, give the resident notice of the policy involved, and offer a chance to respond. Minor issues may resolve with coaching, mediation, or a written agreement. Serious or repeated issues can lead to formal review and restrictions, relocation, or removal under the applicable process.

16.2 Interim actions and review

Housing can restrict access or change a room temporarily when safety or operations require. An interim action is documented separately from the final decision. Written outcomes identify the review office and deadline. Housing decisions ordinarily allow five business days to request review for procedural error, new information, or disproportionate conditions.

CHAPTER 17

Contracts, cancellations and releases

17.1 Before arrival

Submit a cancellation in the housing portal and retain the confirmation. Fall cancellations received by July 10 have no cancellation fee. A late pre-arrival cancellation carries a $180 fee unless waived. Any enrollment withdrawal and dining cancellation must be handled through their respective offices.

17.2 After check-in

Residents may request a release for withdrawal, graduation, relocation for an approved placement, or a documented hardship. Housing confirms the effective date and billing adjustment in writing. Residents seeking a voluntary early exit without an approved release may request a buyout, modeled at 30% of the remaining room charges when available. Leaving the room or returning keys alone does not end charges.

17.3 Temporary suspension and termination

Housing may suspend access during investigation or unsafe building conditions, with terms communicated in writing. Termination notices state the effective date, checkout instructions, charges, and applicable review options. If the university cannot provide assigned housing after a prolonged closure, Housing reviews transfer or release options and unused room charges.

CHAPTER 18

Dining access, food support and expectations

18.1 Entry and meal plans

Use your own campus credential. Residential plans include an allotment of meal entries or unlimited entries depending on the agreement. Guest entries come from a separate balance. Visitors can use the advertised door rate where offered. Wear shoes and a shirt, and keep serving routes accessible.

18.2 Takeout, service changes and meal support

Students can request one reusable takeaway container per eligible meal entry at designated locations. Changes in station schedules or substitutions may occur before close. If illness or an approved accommodation prevents standard pickup, contact Dining Services about meal pickup options. Check the dated menu for holiday and closure details.

18.3 Allergens and dietary information

Menu tags describe recorded ingredients or a verified fictional preparation status. They cannot establish safety for a particular person. Ask the dining supervisor to verify the current recipe, supplier substitutions, and shared equipment. A plant-based tag alone provides no allergy assurance. Unknown values remain unknown.

CHAPTER 19

Technology, outages and public health

19.1 Internet and equipment

Connect through the resident network with your own credentials and register consoles or printers through the device portal. Private wireless routers, credential sharing, and attempts to bypass access controls are prohibited. Submit a service ticket with building, room, device type, and the error time. Avoid including passwords.

19.2 Outages, closures and temporary relocation

During an interruption, Housing posts the affected services, temporary meeting location or alternate facilities, and a time for the next update. Bring essential items and medications if moved to another room. Housing coordinates accessibility needs, continuity of dining, and whether relocation affects billing.

19.3 Public health operations

A campus health notice may temporarily adjust visitor limits, dining service, room assignments, and access to shared spaces. Student Care can help residents who cannot return home during a closure. Housing sends effective dates and the process for accommodation, reassignment, or contract review.

APPENDIX A

Residence hall directory

Desks are staffed 08:00–22:00 weekdays and 10:00–20:00 weekends during regular occupancy.

Alder Hall / North Bank

XXX-6720-8982 | Traditional doubles | Winter break host; community kitchen
100 Riverbend Loop, Grand River University (fictional)

Juniper Hall / North Bank

XXX-6720-8983 | Suites | Winter break host; quiet study wing
120 Riverbend Loop, Grand River University (fictional)

Bracken Hall / Riverwalk

XXX-6720-8984 | Traditional doubles | Substance-free floor; music practice room
140 Riverbend Loop, Grand River University (fictional)

Maple Hall / Riverwalk

XXX-6720-8985 | Suites | Community kitchen; river-facing study lounge
160 Riverbend Loop, Grand River University (fictional)

Heron Hall / South Terrace

XXX-6720-8986 | Traditional singles and doubles | Gender-inclusive room cluster; makers lounge
180 Riverbend Loop, Grand River University (fictional)

Stonebridge Hall / South Terrace

XXX-6720-8987 | Suites | Community kitchen; multipurpose studio
200 Riverbend Loop, Grand River University (fictional)

Cedar Court / South Terrace

XXX-6720-8988 | Apartments | Family housing; outdoor courtyard
220 Riverbend Loop, Grand River University (fictional)

APPENDIX B

Campus services directory

These numbers are fictional placeholders. In a real emergency, contact your local emergency services.

GRU Police Dispatch / XXX-6720-8900
Campus safety dispatch in simulation | 24/7

GRU Police Non-Emergency / XXX-6720-8901
Routine campus safety reports | 24/7

Residential Duty / XXX-6720-8902
Overnight lockouts and urgent building concerns | Outside desk hours

Housing Assignments / XXX-6720-8903
Placements, room moves, contracts and billing | Weekdays 08:30–17:00

Access Services / XXX-6720-8904
Accessibility and housing accommodations | Weekdays 09:00–17:00

Wellness Center / XXX-6720-8905
Counseling scheduling and triage | Weekdays 09:00–17:00

Student Care / XXX-6720-8906
Support after disruption, crisis or hardship | Weekdays 09:00–17:00

Facilities Help Desk / XXX-6720-8907
Routine maintenance and repair tickets | Weekdays 08:00–17:00

Dining Services / XXX-6720-8908
Dining plans, ingredient verification and accommodations | Weekdays 08:30–17:00

Student Programs Board / XXX-6720-8909
Events, attendance and venue questions | Weekdays 10:00–17:00

Campus IT / XXX-6720-8910
Resident network and device support | Daily 08:00–20:00